

Homework 7

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*All of my homework is available at <https://github.com/lacampanella233/Homework.git>.

Problem 1 (5C-1). Prove or give a counterexample: If $T \in \mathcal{L}(V)$ and T^2 has an upper-triangular matrix with respect to some basis of V , then T has an upper-triangular matrix with respect to some basis of V .

Solution. We give a counterexample. Let $V = \mathbb{R}^2$ and let $T \in \mathcal{L}(V)$ be defined by rotating every vector in V by 90° counterclockwise. Then $T^2 = -I$, which obviously has an upper-triangular matrix. However, T does not have an upper-triangular matrix with respect to any basis of V since it has no eigenvalues in $\mathbb{R}$.

Problem 2 (5C-2). Suppose A and B are upper-triangular matrices of the same size, with $\alpha_1, \dots, \alpha_n$ on the diagonal of A and $\beta_1, \dots, \beta_n$ on the diagonal of B .

- (a) Show that $A + B$ is an upper-triangular matrix with $\alpha_1 + \beta_1, \dots, \alpha_n + \beta_n$ on the diagonal.
- (b) Show that AB is an upper-triangular matrix with $\alpha_1\beta_1, \dots, \alpha_n\beta_n$ on the diagonal.

Proof. (a) Denote M_{ij} as the (i, j) -th entry of a matrix M . Since A and B are upper-triangular, we have $A_{ij} = 0$ and $B_{ij} = 0$ for all $i > j$. Therefore, for all $i > j$ and k , we have

$$(A + B)_{ij} = A_{ij} + B_{ij} = 0 + 0 = 0, \quad (A + B)_{kk} = A_{kk} + B_{kk} = \alpha_k + \beta_k.$$

(b) For all $i > j$, we have

$$(AB)_{ij} = \sum_{k=1}^n A_{ik}B_{kj} = 0,$$

since for each term in the sum, either $i > k$ or $k > j$. For the diagonal entries, we have

$$(AB)_{kk} = \sum_{j=1}^n A_{kj}B_{jk} = A_{kk}B_{kk} = \alpha_k\beta_k.$$

□

Problem 3 (5C-3). Suppose $T \in \mathcal{L}(V)$ is invertible and $v_1, \dots, v_n$ is a basis of V with respect to which the matrix of T is upper triangular, with $\lambda_1, \dots, \lambda_n$ on the diagonal. Show that the matrix of T^{-1} is also upper triangular with respect to the basis $v_1, \dots, v_n$, with

$$\frac{1}{\lambda_1}, \dots, \frac{1}{\lambda_n}$$

on the diagonal.

Proof. Denote the diagonal entries of the matrix of T^{-1} by $\mu_1, \dots, \mu_n$. By the previous problem, the matrix of $TT^{-1} = I$ is upper-triangular with $\lambda_1\mu_1, \dots, \lambda_n\mu_n$ on the diagonal. Since the matrix of I has 1 on the diagonal, we have $\lambda_k\mu_k = 1$ for all $k = 1, \dots, n$. Therefore, $\mu_k = 1/\lambda_k$ for all $k = 1, \dots, n$. $\square$

Problem 4 (5C-8). Suppose V is finite-dimensional, $T \in \mathcal{L}(V)$, and there exists a nonzero vector $v \in V$ such that $T^2v + 2Tv = -2v$.

- Prove that if $\mathbb{F} = \mathbb{R}$, then there does not exist a basis of V with respect to which T has an upper-triangular matrix.
- Prove that if $\mathbb{F} = \mathbb{C}$ and A is an upper-triangular matrix that equals the matrix of T with respect to some basis of V , then $-1 + i$ or $-1 - i$ appears on the diagonal of A .

Proof. (a) Denote the matrix of T with respect to some basis of V by A , such that A is upper triangular. Then the matrix of $T^2 + 2T + 2I$ is $A^2 + 2A + 2I$, which is also upper triangular and with diagonal entries $\lambda^2 + 2\lambda + 2$, where λ is a diagonal entry of A . Since $\lambda \in \mathbb{R}$, we have $\lambda^2 + 2\lambda + 2 > 0$, which shows that $A^2 + 2A + 2I$ is invertible. However, since $T^2v + 2Tv = -2v$, we have $(T^2 + 2T + 2I)v = 0$, which contradicts the invertibility of $A^2 + 2A + 2I$.

(b) The same argument as in (a) shows that $A^2 + 2A + 2I$ is not invertible, which means that there exists a diagonal entry λ of A such that $\lambda^2 + 2\lambda + 2 = 0$. Solving this equation gives $\lambda = -1 + i$ or $\lambda = -1 - i$. $\square$

Problem 5 (5C-12). Suppose V is finite-dimensional, $T \in \mathcal{L}(V)$ has an upper-triangular matrix with respect to some basis of V , and U is a subspace of V that is invariant under T .

- Prove that $T|_U$ has an upper-triangular matrix with respect to some basis of U .
- Prove that the quotient operator T/U has an upper-triangular matrix with respect to some basis of V/U .

Proof. (a) Let $v_1, \dots, v_n$ be a basis of V such that the matrix of T with respect to this basis is upper triangular, and let $V_k = \text{span}\{v_1, \dots, v_k\}$. Then, $\dim V_k = k$, and $\{0\} = V_0 \subset V_1 \subset \dots \subset V_n = V$ is a sequence of subspaces that are invariant under T .

We will show that $\{0\} = (V_0 \cap U) \subset (V_1 \cap U) \subset \dots \subset (V_n \cap U) = U$ is a sequence of subspaces that are invariant under $T|_U$ with $\dim(V_{k+1} \cap U) - \dim(V_k \cap U) \leq 1$ for all $k = 0, \dots, n-1$. Since

$V_{k+1} = V_k + \text{span}\{v_{k+1}\}$, we have

$$V_{k+1} \cap U = (V_k + \text{span}\{v_{k+1}\}) \cap U = (V_k \cap U) + (\text{span}\{v_{k+1}\} \cap U).$$

Therefore

$$\dim(V_{k+1} \cap U) = \dim(V_k \cap U) + \dim(\text{span}\{v_{k+1}\} \cap U) - \dim(V_k \cap \text{span}\{v_{k+1}\} \cap U) \leq \dim(V_k \cap U) + 1.$$

Denote $m = \dim U$. Then there exists $0 = i_0 < i_1 < \cdots < i_m = n$ such that $\dim(V_{i_k} \cap U) = k$ for all $k = 0, \dots, m$. Pick $u_k \in (V_{i_k} \cap U) - (V_{i_{k-1}} \cap U)$, then $\{u_1, \dots, u_m\}$ is a basis of U . Moreover, for any $1 \leq k \leq m$, $\{u_1, \dots, u_k\}$ is a basis of $V_{i_k} \cap U$. Therefore, the matrix of $T|_U$ with respect to the basis $u_1, \dots, u_m$ is upper triangular.

(b) We will consider the sequence of subspaces

$$\{0\} = (V_0 + U)/U \subset (V_1 + U)/U \subset \cdots \subset (V_n + U)/U = V/U.$$

Note that

$$\begin{aligned} \dim((V_{k+1} + U)/U) &= \dim(V_{k+1} + U) - \dim U = \dim V_{k+1} + \dim U - \dim(V_{k+1} \cap U) - \dim U \\ &= \dim V_{k+1} - \dim(V_{k+1} \cap U) \leq 1 + \dim V_k - \dim(V_k \cap U) \\ &= 1 + \dim((V_k + U)/U). \end{aligned}$$

Then the similar argument as in (a) shows that there exists a basis of V/U with respect to which the matrix of T/U is upper triangular. $\square$

Problem 6 (5C-13). Suppose V is finite-dimensional and $T \in \mathcal{L}(V)$. Suppose there exists a subspace U of V that is invariant under T such that $T|_U$ has an upper-triangular matrix with respect to some basis of U and also T/U has an upper-triangular matrix with respect to some basis of V/U . Prove that T has an upper-triangular matrix with respect to some basis of V .

Proof. Denote $\{u_1, \dots, u_m\}$ the basis of U such that the matrix of $T|_U$ with respect to this basis is upper triangular, and denote $\{v_1 + U, \dots, v_n + U\}$ the basis of V/U such that the matrix of T/U with respect to this basis is upper triangular. We will show that $\{u_1, \dots, u_m, v_1, \dots, v_n\}$ is a basis of V such that the matrix of T with respect to this basis is upper triangular.

First, for any $1 \leq k \leq m$, we have $\text{span}\{u_1, \dots, u_k\}$ is T -invariant since the matrix of $T|_U$ with respect to the basis $u_1, \dots, u_m$ is upper triangular. Next, for any $1 \leq k \leq n$, we have

$$\begin{aligned} T(v_k) + U &= (T/U)(v_k + U) \in \text{span}\{v_1 + U, \dots, v_k + U\} \subset \text{span}\{u_1, \dots, u_m, v_1, \dots, v_k\} + U \\ &\implies T(v_k) \in \text{span}\{u_1, \dots, u_m, v_1, \dots, v_k\}. \end{aligned}$$

Then, $\text{span}\{u_1, \dots, u_m, v_1, \dots, v_k\}$ is T -invariant for all $1 \leq k \leq n$. Therefore, the matrix of T with respect to the basis $u_1, \dots, u_m, v_1, \dots, v_n$ is upper triangular. $\square$

Problem 7 (5C-14). Suppose V is finite-dimensional and $T \in \mathcal{L}(V)$. Prove that T has an upper-triangular matrix with respect to some basis of V if and only if the dual operator T^* has an upper-triangular matrix with respect to some basis of the dual space V^* .

Proof. Since V is finite-dimensional, we can treat V^{**} as V . Then we only need to show “ $\implies$ ”.

Let $\mathcal{B} := \{v_1, \dots, v_n\}$ be a basis of V such that the matrix of T with respect to this basis is upper triangular, and let $\mathcal{B}^* := \{\varphi_1, \dots, \varphi_n\}$ be the dual basis of V^* . Then we have

$$\mathcal{M}(T, \mathcal{B}) = (\mathcal{M}(T^*, \mathcal{B}^*))^T.$$

Then the matrix of T^* with respect to the basis $\mathcal{B}^*$ is lower-triangular matrix, which implies that the matrix of T with respect to the basis $\{\varphi_n, \varphi_{n-1}, \dots, \varphi_1\}$ is upper triangular. $\square$